



CANTONAL POLICE · SANKT OSWIN POST · CASE 36/1218



Envelope A

The night of the Nocturne

Open this envelope first.

- ☐ **A1** Letter from the inspector
- ☐ **A2** Scene report: compartment 5
- ☐ **A3** Police photograph
- ☐ **A4** The seven suspects
- ☐ **A5** Timetable and route guide
- ☐ **A6** Plan of the train
- ☐ **A7** First interviews
- ☐ **A8** Witness statements
- ☐ **A9** Letter from J. Morand
- ☐ **A10** Basel customs slip

Cut out the label along the dashed line and stick it on an envelope, or keep this sheet on top of the pile.

How to work this case

You are two detectives, and this is your case file. The game on your laptop or phone is headquarters: it guards the locked evidence, holds the hints, and hears your final accusation.

Write on everything. Circle times, underline anything that sounds like a lie, cross out suspects. Times matter in this case more than in most: keep the timeline worksheet next to you.

The envelopes

- **Envelope A** is yours now.
- **Envelope B** stays sealed until you open Monsieur Delorme's dispatch case in the game.
- **Envelope C** stays sealed until you tell the inspector what Morand's letter really says.
- **Envelope D** stays sealed until you name the author of a torn note.

Good to know

- Everything in the envelopes is also in the game, so you can zoom in on screen whenever the paper is too small.
- A magnifying glass makes the photographs more fun. Your phone camera's zoom works too.
- Some pages are meant to be cut: a reading card and a torn note. Scissors, and a craft knife for the card's little windows, will help.
- Stuck? The game has three hints for each lock, from gentle to generous.
- When you are both sure, fill in the accusation form together, then enter it in the game to hear the verdict. You only get one.



CANTONAL POLICE

Sankt Oswin post · Inspector A. Tscharner

Sankt Oswin station, Saturday 19 December 1936, 03:15

Dear Detectives _____ and _____,

Forgive me for knocking at your compartment at this hour. The attendant of your car tells me you are detectives. He also tells me that you both went to bed at ten o'clock and never stirred, which makes you the only two people on this train I am sure of.

At six minutes past midnight, Casimir Delorme, the watchmaker of La Chaux-de-Fonds, was found shot dead in his berth in compartment 5 of sleeping car 2. His door to the corridor was bolted and chained on the inside.

An avalanche has buried the line beyond Sankt Oswin. The Alpine Nocturne will not move before the snowplough reaches us, the pass road is closed, and nobody leaves this train. I am the only policeman for thirty kilometres, and I am a village policeman.

Seven passengers had a reason, or a chance, to want Monsieur Delorme dead. Everything I have so far is in this file. As my search goes on, I will pass you more in sealed envelopes. Some things only you can open for me, starting with Monsieur Delorme's dispatch case.

By the time the snowplough gets through, I need to know who killed Casimir Delorme, how it was done, when, and why.

Everyone on this train has a watch. Trust none of them.

A. Tscharner

Inspector, Cantonal Police

Scene report: sleeping car 2, compartment 5

CONFIDENTIAL

Train The Alpine Nocturne, Paris-Vienna, held at Sankt Oswin station since 23:59 (avalanche on the line ahead)

Victim Casimir Delorme, 67, of La Chaux-de-Fonds, founder of Delorme & Cie, watchmakers

Found 00:06, by the attendant Emil Stoffel and Mrs Margit Delorme

Police aboard 00:40

Doctor Dr Ursina Caflisch, village doctor, examined the body at 00:55

How he was found

At 00:04 the attendant knocked to wake Mr Delorme, who had asked to be woken at Sankt Oswin. No answer. The attendant unlocked the door with his key, but the safety chain was on and the door opened only four centimetres. He fetched Mrs Delorme from compartment 6, which joins no. 5 by a communicating door, and they went in that way.

The body (marker 1)

In the berth, on his back, in pyjamas. Shot once in the head at close range through a pillow: a scorched hole, feathers everywhere. No weapon anywhere in the compartment.

Doors and window

- Corridor door: locked, bolted and on the chain from inside.
- Communicating door to compartment 6 (marker 2): the bolt on the side of no. 5 was drawn back, that is, open. The bolt on the side of no. 6 was also open.
- Window: shut, blind half down.

On the folding table

- Marker 3: a bottle of Vichy water, half empty; a glass; a folded paper from a sleeping powder (veronal), empty.
- Marker 4: Mr Delorme's gold hunter watch, open, going, and correct to the minute.

Elsewhere

- Marker 5: black leather dispatch case, initials C. D., shut with a four-wheel combination lock. Not forced. Nobody aboard knows the combination.
- Marker 6: his jacket on the hook. In the pockets: a wallet with 420 Swiss and 1,100 French francs; passport; ticket; a receipt from the Zurich station telegraph office, 18 Dec., 20:55, for two telegrams, reply paid: one to the *Pfarramt Sankt Oswin* (the parish priest), 24 words, and one to *J. Morand, Innsbruck*, 13 words; replies to "Delorme, Alpine Nocturne, Sankt Oswin station". Also a typewritten letter from J. Morand of Innsbruck (A9).

Nothing appears to have been taken.

(AT) *The stationmaster is out on the line with the avalanche crew and his office is locked. I'll ask him about any telegrams as soon as he is back.*

Compartment 5, photographed at 01:20 by Otto Kessler of Die Woche im Bild at the inspector's request, after the body was moved to the luggage van. The numbered markers match the scene report. A magnifying glass helps.



The seven suspects

Everyone else aboard was asleep, in plain view of the staff, or had never met Mr Delorme. I have checked. That leaves these seven. — A. T.



Baron Friedrich von Aschau

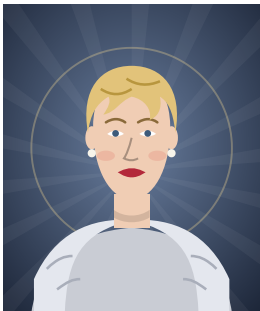
Investor, 37

From Austrian, raised in Argentina

Compartment Car 2, no. 9

Born in Buenos Aires in 1899, son of an Austrian landowner; came to Europe in 1933 to take up the family estate near Innsbruck. A keen mountaineer until August 1934, when he survived a fall on the north face of the Grauhorn in which his guide was killed, and spent four months in hospital in Innsbruck. Scar on the left cheek; lost the top of the little finger of his left hand in the fall. Travelling with Mr Delorme to Vienna, where on Monday he was to sign for a 40% share in Delorme & Cie for two million francs.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared



Margit Delorme

The victim's wife, 34

From Hungarian

Compartment Car 2, no. 6

Née Szabó. A figure skater who skated for Hungary at the 1928 Winter Games. Married Casimir Delorme in 1931 as his second wife. Wore a silver-fox wrap tonight. Her compartment connects to her husband's through a communicating door.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared



Raoul Delorme

The victim's son, 39

From Swiss

Compartment Car 1, no. 3

Mr Delorme's son by his first marriage and sales director of Delorme & Cie. Lives in Geneva. A familiar face at the casinos of Évian and Monte Carlo.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared



Tomislav Barić

Watchmaker, 46

From Yugoslav, from Zagreb

Compartment Car 2, no. 2

Worked for Delorme & Cie in La Chaux-de-Fonds from 1919 to 1926, then went home to Zagreb and opened his own workshop. Travelling to Vienna. Has a crate in the luggage van.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared



Emil Stoffel

Sleeping-car attendant, 52

From Swiss

Compartment Attendant, car 2

With the Société Transalpine for 24 years, and attendant of car 2 on the Nocturne since 1930. His seat is at the front end of the car. Carries the square key that opens the lock of every compartment in car 2.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared



Constance Pryor

Journalist, 32

From British

Compartment Car 2, no. 4

Writes for The Clarion, a London weekly. Travelling alone to Vienna “for a story”. Takes notes in shorthand.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared



Klara Imhof

Private secretary, 28

From Swiss, from Bern

Compartment Car 2, no. 7

Mr Delorme’s private secretary for six years. Travels with him everywhere, keeps his diary and his correspondence.

☐ Suspicious ☐ Cleared

Cut out the cards along the dashed lines if you like.



The Alpine Nocturne

TRAIN DE LUXE · SLEEPING CARS ONLY · WINTER SERVICE 1936-37

Paris - Basel - Zurich - Sankt Oswin - Innsbruck - Vienna

STATION	ARR.	DEP.
Paris-Est		11.50 ¹
Troyes	13.26 ¹	13.28 ¹
Chaumont	14.34 ¹	14.36 ¹
Belfort	17.18 ¹	17.22 ¹
Mulhouse	17.56 ¹	17.58 ¹
Saint-Louis, <i>frontier</i>		18.27 ¹ <i>passes</i>
Basel SBB	19.34 ²	19.52 ²
Zurich HB	20.48	21.02
Sargans	22.00	22.03
<i>Grauhorn Tunnel</i>	22.24	22.35
Pradella	23.06	23.08
Sankt Oswin	23.59	00.04
Innsbruck Hbf	03.40	03.52
Wien Westbahnhof	10.15	

¹ French time. ² From the frontier onwards, all times are Central European Time, one hour ahead of French time. Passengers are kindly asked to put their watches forward one hour as the train crosses the frontier.

On the way

Basel. Swiss customs and passports on board. Change of engine; the dining car joins the train.

The Grauhorn Tunnel. 8.7 km beneath the Grauhorn (3,412 m). From Sargans the Oswin Railway hauls the Nocturne by steam, and in the tunnel we run at a steady 48 km/h: eleven minutes in the dark. It is the only tunnel of any length on our route. Kindly keep windows closed in the tunnel; the smoke is considerable.

Sankt Oswin. Mountain village at the foot of the Grauhorn's south face. Telegrams for passengers may be collected at the station office during our five-minute stop.

Services

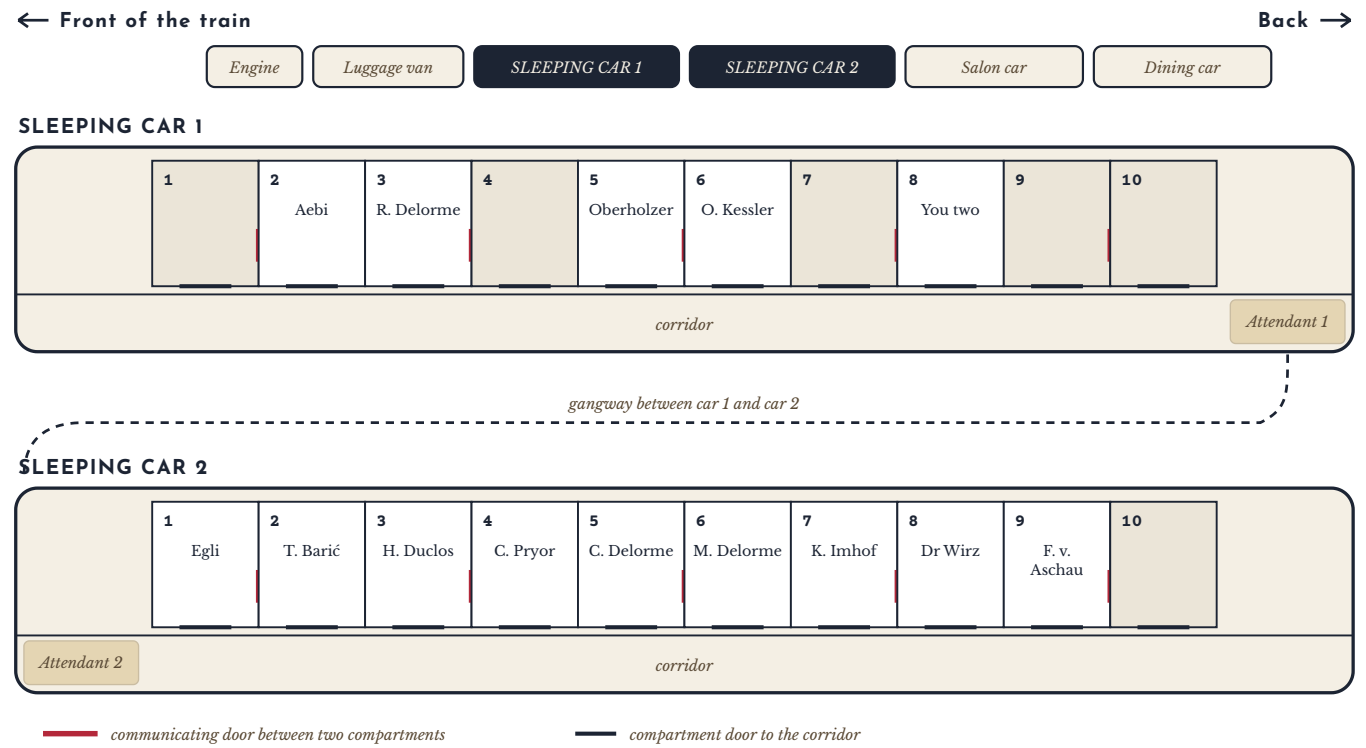
Dining car: first sitting 19.55, second sitting 21.00. The dining car closes at 22.00.

Salon car: bar and writing desk, open until 01.00. Drinks may be signed for and settled at Vienna.

Attendants: ring once for your attendant, twice for the bar. Your attendant will wake you at any hour you wish.

SOCIÉTÉ TRANSALPINE DE WAGONS-LITS

Plan of the Alpine Nocturne, night of 18-19 December



First interviews, 01:00 to 02:45

Taken in the dining car, one at a time. Their own words, as near as I could write them. — A. T.



Baron Friedrich von Aschau
Investor

“I’ve known Casimir since September; we were to sign in Vienna on Monday. I dined with him, his wife and his son at the first sitting. Casimir was quiet, odd even. He left before the dessert to send a wire at Zurich. Business, I suppose.”

“At about a quarter past nine I stopped at his compartment to say goodnight. He said he wanted one more day to think about the agreement and that I would have his answer at Sankt Oswin. Old men get cold feet. I wasn’t worried.”

“Then I wrote letters in my compartment until about ten. At a quarter past ten I went along to the salon car and sat with Madame Duclos, a delightful old lady. We talked about the Andes. I left her at a quarter to eleven and went to bed. I heard nothing until the attendant started shouting at midnight, and after that I stayed in my compartment.”

“Sankt Oswin? I was carried through it on a stretcher in 1934. I remember nothing of the place and hoped never to see it again. The avalanche has a cruel sense of humour.”

(AT) *Hands unsteady; he says it is the cold. Wears a gold Delorme wristwatch, which he tells me Casimir made for him in 1931.*



Margit Delorme
The victim's wife

“I had one of my migraines. After dinner I went to my compartment. At about ten I knocked on the communicating door and said goodnight to Casimir. He was reading in bed and said he’d taken his powder. Then I lay down in the dark, fell asleep and heard nothing at all until the attendant woke me at midnight.”

“Casimir never bolted his side of that door. He liked to think I might come in. I never bolted mine either.”

“My pistol? It’s in my dressing case. The whole corridor saw it at Basel, when the customs officer made his little scene. I carry it because I so often travel alone.”

“Was I happy? I was married to a clock, Inspector. He was kind and he was punctual, and he was never once late for anything in his life.”



Raoul Delorme

The victim's son

“Yes, I went to see my father after dinner, at about half past nine, and yes, we shouted. I expect the whole car heard. He was selling forty per cent of the firm to a man he'd known for three months and making him a director over my head.”

“I said, “You'd let a stranger into the firm before your own son?” And he said the oddest thing. He laughed and said, “A stranger? You have no idea how right you are.” Then he told me to get out.”

“I went back to my compartment in car 1 at about five to ten and stayed there. I read, I slept, I saw nobody. I didn't kill my father. I don't need his money that badly.”

(AT) *Smelled of cognac. Answered every question before I had finished asking it.*



Tomislav Barić

Watchmaker

“I will not pretend I liked him. In 1924 I built an escapement that runs ten years without oil. Delorme patented it in his own name, and he has sold a hundred thousand “Nocturne” watches with my heart inside them. On Tuesday my case is heard in Vienna.”

“At dinner I lost my temper. I told him that before this night was over he would answer for what he stole. I meant the court papers: my lawyer asked me to put a copy in his hands before the hearing.”

“At a quarter past ten I went to the luggage van to see to my clock, the prototype, in crate 14. It is the proof of my case, and the van is cold. When I came back I knocked on his door to give him the papers. No answer. I went to bed.”

“You are looking at my hands, Inspector. Yes, with the tools in my bag I could open most locks on this train. I did not open his.”

(AT) *A roll of fine watchmaker's picks and drivers in his bag.*



Emil Stoffel

Sleeping-car attendant

“At five past ten Monsieur Delorme rang. I brought him his Vichy water and his sleeping powder, as every night. He asked me to wake him at Sankt Oswin: “a letter will be waiting for me there.” As I went out I heard him put the chain on behind me.”

“Then I sat at my post at the end of the corridor until midnight. I never left it. Nobody went into number 5 or number 6. At about twenty to eleven the Croatian gentleman knocked at number 5, got no answer and went back to his compartment.”

“At four minutes past midnight I knocked to wake him. The chain was on. I fetched Madame from number 6 and we went in through the communicating door. I'll not forget it.”

“Did he say anything else tonight? He said, “I have written to your company, Stoffel.” About November. He was a hard man about drink.”



Constance Pryor

Journalist

“I’d never met the man before tonight. I dined at the first sitting, at a table of my own, and read in my compartment afterwards.”

“At a quarter past nine I passed his door and heard him say to someone, “You’ll have my answer at Sankt Oswin, not before.””

“At about a quarter past ten I went to the salon car for a gin fizz and to write. I stayed at the bar until just after we came out of the long tunnel, then walked back to bed. As I came into car 2 the Croatian gentleman was knocking at number 5 and nobody answered. That was about twenty to eleven. I remember that the attendant’s seat at the far end of the car was empty; I wanted a hot-water bottle and there was no one to ask.”

“Why am I on this train? I’m writing about the Alps in winter.”

(AT) Her notebook is in shorthand. She would not let me read it.



Klara Imhof

Private secretary

“I have been Monsieur Delorme’s secretary for six years. After dinner, at a quarter to ten, I took my portfolio to the writing desk in the salon car and wrote up his letters until nearly eleven. Then I went to bed.”

“He was not himself after dinner. At Zurich he got down to send two telegrams himself; he never does that, he always sends me. When he came back he asked whether I remembered the baron’s watch being ordered in 1931. I didn’t. I was in the Geneva office then.”

“The dispatch case? He resets the combination at the start of every journey. He sets it to the minute the train crosses into Switzerland, and by Swiss time, always. “A Swiss watchmaker keeps Swiss time,” he used to say. I never knew the numbers. It amused him that I didn’t.”

(AT) Wept throughout.

Witness statements



Honorine Duclos

Passenger, car 2, no. 3

“I am eighty-one, Inspector, and I sleep badly on trains, so I sit up in the salon car. I went there after the second sitting and had my first tisane at about twenty past nine.”

“The baron came and sat with me at a quarter past ten. I know because he asked me the time and I looked at my watch; it is my Albert’s watch, and I keep it open on the table in front of me. The moment he sat down he ordered me a fresh camomile and a cognac for himself, and he told me about the mountains of the Argentine. Such a gentleman. At a quarter to eleven he asked me the time again, kissed my hand and went to bed. He never left my table in all that time.”

“My daughter writes that I must take my drops at seven o’clock, and I took them just as we pulled out of Basel, at eight minutes to seven. The customs men had been very rude to that poor Hungarian lady.”

“After the baron left I dozed in my chair until the train stopped and everyone began to run about.”



Henri Vautier

Steward, dining car

“First sitting, 19:55. At the Delorme table: Monsieur and Madame Delorme, Monsieur Raoul and the baron. Monsieur Delorme hardly ate. He kept looking at the baron’s wrist, the way a jeweller looks at a stone. Once he asked him, “Does it still strike the quarters for you?” The baron laughed and said he never bothered with the thing.”

“The English lady at table 3 left at five past eight, before her main course came.”

“At about half past eight the gentleman at table 7, Monsieur Barić, stood up and shouted at Monsieur Delorme: “Before this night is over, you will answer for what you stole!” I asked him to sit down, and he did.”

“At twenty to nine Monsieur Delorme got up before his dessert and said he had to send a wire at Zurich. The dining car closed at ten, as it always does.”



J. MORAND

HORLOGERIE · RHABILLAGES · INNSBRUCK, TIROL

Innsbruck, 14 December 1936

Monsieur C. Delorme
Delorme & Cie, La Chaux-de-Fonds

Dear Monsieur Delorme,

Thank you for your letter of the 2nd. I regret that the cold has kept me from the bench, but your chronometer will be ready before Christmas. The engraver promises the case back by Friday, and I shall send it on to you at once. Your instructions for the balance I have followed to the letter.

As to the other matter: I went over the pass by way of Sankt Anton, as you asked, and called on my cousin Oswin, who still keeps the old ledgers of the valley. He holds that nothing up there is quite what it seems. A curious business, and I will say no more of it on paper. The undertaker of 1934 is an old man now, but he remembers everything. You will understand when we meet.

Finally, the repeater you sent me has a winding stem cut for a left-hand thread, which is why it would not take. I have handed it to my apprentice to re-cut. The best man for such work is away in Geneva until January.

With my respectful greetings,

J. Morand

Typewritten on one sheet. Found folded in the inside pocket of Mr Delorme's jacket.

SWISS FEDERAL CUSTOMS · BASEL SBB

NO. 4471

Declaration of firearms carried by a traveller

Date and time 18 December 1936, 19:41
Train The Alpine Nocturne, sleeping car 2
Traveller Mrs Margit Delorme, compartment 6
Weapon Automatic pistol, FN Herstal, calibre 6.35 mm, “Baby” model
Serial number 81 604
Ammunition Six cartridges in the magazine
Permit Hungarian firearms permit no. 2207/1934, in order
Decision Returned to the owner

Remarks. The lady objected loudly to the inspection, which was carried out in the corridor in view of several passengers (car 2, nos. 2, 4, 7 and 9). The pistol was put back in her dressing case in their sight.

Customs officer Gisler